Responsible Administrator: VP Student Affairs
Responsible Office: Dean of Students
Effective Date: Spring 2025
Approved by: President
Date Reviewed (no substantive changes): 01/07/2025

Food Safety Policy

Policy Statement

Southeastern Louisiana University is committed to ensuring the health and safety of students, faculty, staff, and visitors by establishing clear standards for food preparation, handling, and distribution on campus. This policy sets forth food safety requirements to prevent foodborne illness and promote responsible food handling practices in all campus-related events involving food.

Purpose of Policy

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures and guidelines for the safe handling, preparation, and distribution of food on Southeastern's campus. Through this policy, the University aims to protect the health of all individuals participating in campus events and activities that involve food.

Applicability

This policy applies to all departments, organizations, student groups, and individuals involved in food preparation, distribution, or sale on Southeastern Louisiana University property. It encompasses campus events, gatherings, fundraisers, and other activities that provide or sell food to students, faculty, staff, and visitors. All athletic-related activities and vending are exempt from this policy and are governed by their respective departmental policies and procedures.

Policy Procedure

The following procedures outline the requirements for food safety compliance and the handling of food on Southeastern's campus. All individuals and organizations involved in food service must adhere to these guidelines to maintain safe and sanitary conditions at campus events.

1. Requirements for Food Safety Compliance

To ensure all food served on campus is prepared safely, the University mandates training and adherence to hygiene standards for all individuals involved in food handling. These requirements aim to protect public health by promoting responsible practices in food preparation and serving.

- **Food Safety Training**: Any individual or group intending to prepare or serve food on campus must complete a university-approved food safety course. This training covers essential food handling, preparation, and storage practices, ensuring food safety at all University events. This course will be offered at no cost to the individual or organization. The individual(s) in charge of the planned food preparation and certified as having completed the class must submit proof of training completion to the Dean of Students office prior to any food-related event. The food safety course is provided online as part of the University Registration of Activities process, available at www.selu.edu/roa. For more information, contact the Office of the Dean of Students at 985-549-3792 or deanofstudents@southeastern.edu.

- **Health and Hygiene Standards**: Individuals involved in food handling must adhere to personal hygiene standards, including regular handwashing, wearing gloves when handling ready-to-eat foods, and using hair restraints. Individuals exhibiting signs of illness are prohibited from food handling.

2. Food Preparation and Handling Guidelines

Maintaining safe temperatures, preventing contamination, and carefully handling high-risk foods are key practices to reduce the risk of foodborne illnesses. Southeastern requires adherence to the following food handling guidelines to ensure safe service at all events.

- **Temperature Control**:
    - Hot foods must be maintained at 135°F or above, while cold foods must be kept at 41°F or below. Temperature logs should be maintained during events to ensure proper food temperature control.
- **Cross-Contamination Prevention**: Separate utensils, cutting boards, and storage containers are required for raw and cooked foods to prevent cross-contamination. Food handlers must sanitize surfaces and equipment before and after use.
- **High-Risk Food Items**: Particular caution is required for high-risk items, including dairy, eggs, meat, poultry, and seafood. Food handlers must adhere to all guidelines from the food safety training for these items.

3. Inspection and Approval

The University reserves the right to inspect any food preparation area or food handling practice to ensure compliance with this policy. Event organizers may be required to provide documentation such as proof of training completion and temperature logs.

4. Exemptions and Limitations

Certain items may be exempt from this policy, such as commercially pre-packaged foods that do not require temperature control and single-serve items (e.g., individually wrapped snacks). However, all large-scale events or activities involving catered food will be subject to inspection and may require additional compliance measures.

5. Catering Procedures

Southeastern allows on-campus events to be catered by approved University vendors and recognizes the importance of following food safety protocols, whether the food is catered internally or by an external vendor. By choosing Southeastern Catering, the group or event automatically complies with food safety standards, with no additional requirements needed. These guidelines ensure that catered events meet University standards for food safety and health.

- **Approved University Vendors:** Only catering services that have been pre-approved by the University are authorized to provide food for campus events. Approved vendors have demonstrated compliance with Southeastern's food safety standards and are trained in safe food handling practices.
- **Catering Events for Faculty and Staff:** Faculty and staff events, whether organized by a university department or an external organization using university facilities, must adhere to Southeastern's catering and food safety policies. The University's approved vendors should be prioritized for faculty and staff events to ensure compliance with health and safety requirements.
- **Using External Vendors for University Events:** When an external vendor is used to cater an event on University property, the event organizers must ensure that the vendor complies with Southeastern's food safety policy and is properly licensed and insured. All external caterers must provide documentation of food safety certifications, proof of insurance, and compliance with the University's food handling standards prior to the event.

Southeastern Catering is the exclusive caterer for the War Memorial Student Union. While it is strongly encouraged that Southeastern catering be used throughout campus, outside caterers may be used at other campus locations as long as the licensure and insurance requirements are met. Event organizers are responsible for coordinating with the Dean of Students to verify that any external vendors meet these requirements. Non-compliance with University food safety and catering standards may result in restrictions on future use of

external catering services for campus events. For more information, contact the Office of the Dean of Students at 985-549-3792 or deanofstudents@southeastern.edu.

6. Enforcement and Consequences

Non-compliance with this policy may result in prohibitions on future food-related events, suspension of privileges for the organization or individual involved, or other disciplinary actions as deemed appropriate by the Dean of Students. Southeastern reserves the right to take further action as necessary to protect public health.

[End of Policy]